CASE STUDY

Nordcenter ApS

Implementation of a CCTV Surveillance System

Case type: Fictional GDPR / DPIA portfolio project
Jurisdiction: Denmark (EU)
Project status: Planned – not yet implemented

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1. Organisation

Nordcenter ApS is a privately owned Danish company that operates a large shopping centre in Aarhus, Denmark.

The shopping centre contains approximately 90 retail stores, restaurants and cafés and receives an estimated 80,000 visitors per week.

Nordcenter ApS is responsible for managing the shopping centre's common areas, facilities and security arrangements.

The company employs approximately 35 people, including administration, facility management and an internal security team.

Individual retail stores operate independently and are responsible for their own activities.

2. Project background

Nordcenter ApS has experienced several incidents involving theft, vandalism and aggressive behaviour in the shopping centre's common areas.

The company currently relies on security patrols and incident reports. Management considers these arrangements insufficient for detecting and investigating security incidents.

Nordcenter ApS therefore proposes implementing a new CCTV surveillance system to improve security in the shopping centre.

The system has not yet been purchased or implemented.

Before proceeding, management has requested a Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA) to evaluate the proposed processing of personal data.

3. Purpose of the processing

The proposed CCTV system is intended to:

- Deter and help detect theft, vandalism and violent incidents in the shopping centre's common areas.
- Support the investigation and documentation of specific security incidents.

The system is not intended to monitor employee performance, analyse customer behaviour for marketing purposes or track individual visitors.

4. Proposed CCTV system

Nordcenter ApS plans to install 120 fixed CCTV cameras throughout the shopping centre.

The cameras will cover:

- Main entrances and exits.
- Public corridors and walkways.
- Central atriums and seating areas.
- Common areas near escalators and lifts.

The cameras will operate continuously, including outside the shopping centre's opening hours.

The system will record video without audio.

It will not use facial recognition, biometric identification, automated behaviour analysis or artificial intelligence.

Cameras will not be installed inside toilets, changing rooms, individual retail stores or staff-only welfare facilities.

5. Personal data

The proposed system will process video recordings of identifiable individuals.

The recordings may contain:

- Images of individuals' faces and physical appearance.
- Clothing and other visible identifying characteristics.
- Individuals' movements and activities within the monitored areas.
- Dates, times and camera locations associated with recordings.

The system will not deliberately collect names, contact details or identity documents.

However, recordings may incidentally reveal information about individuals' personal circumstances or behaviour.

6. Data subjects

The processing will primarily concern:

- Shopping centre visitors and customers.
- Employees of Nordcenter ApS.
- Employees of retail stores, restaurants and cafés.
- Contractors, delivery personnel and other individuals accessing the monitored common areas.

Children and other potentially vulnerable individuals may also be recorded when visiting the shopping centre.

7. Data controller

Nordcenter ApS

Aarhus, Denmark

Nordcenter ApS will determine the purposes and essential means of the CCTV processing, including:

- The areas to be monitored.
- The purposes of surveillance.
- The retention period.
- Authorised access to recordings.
- Conditions for reviewing, exporting and disclosing recordings.

Nordcenter ApS will act as the data controller under GDPR.

8. Data processor

SecureVision ApS

Aarhus, Denmark

SecureVision ApS is a Danish security technology company responsible for implementing and maintaining the proposed CCTV system.

Its responsibilities will include:

- Installing and configuring CCTV cameras and recording equipment.
- Maintaining and updating the system.
- Troubleshooting technical problems.
- Performing technical maintenance that may involve access to stored recordings.

SecureVision ApS will process personal data only on documented instructions from Nordcenter ApS.

The companies intend to enter into a data processing agreement before any personal data is processed.

SecureVision ApS will not use subprocessors for this project.

9. Storage and access

Video recordings will be stored on a dedicated server located within Nordcenter's premises in Aarhus.

The system will not use cloud storage.

Recordings will be retained for 14 days and automatically deleted after that period.

Recordings relevant to a specific security incident may be preserved for longer where legally permitted and necessary for investigation or legal proceedings.

Only designated members of Nordcenter's internal security team will have routine access to recordings.

SecureVision ApS may receive temporary, restricted technical access when necessary for maintenance or troubleshooting.

The proposed system will support individual user accounts, role-based access permissions and logging of access to recordings.

10. Disclosure and international transfers

Nordcenter ApS may disclose relevant video recordings to the Danish police where permitted by applicable law and necessary for investigating suspected criminal offences.

The proposed system does not involve routine disclosure of recordings to retailers, marketing companies or other commercial third parties.

All processing and storage will take place in Denmark.

No transfers of personal data outside the EU/EEA are planned.

11. Project responsibilities

The following internal functions will participate in the project:

Function	Responsibility
Management	Project approval and overall accountability
Facility Management	Proposed camera locations and physical installation
Security Team	Operational use of the CCTV system
IT Administration	Internal technical infrastructure and access management
Privacy / Compliance	DPIA, data protection requirements and compliance assessment

Nordcenter ApS has assigned its Privacy Analyst to conduct the DPIA before management makes a final implementation decision.

12. Project status

The CCTV project is currently in the planning phase.

The proposed technical and operational arrangements described above represent the system that management wishes to implement.

No CCTV equipment has been installed as part of this project, and no personal data processing has begun.

The DPIA must be completed before implementation.

Management will use the DPIA findings to determine whether the project can proceed as proposed, requires modifications or should not proceed.

Important: The proposed arrangements described in this case have not been approved as legally compliant. Their necessity, proportionality, lawfulness and adequacy must be assessed as part of the DPIA.

End of case study.

This is a fictional training scenario. All organisations, circumstances and operational arrangements are invented for portfolio and educational purposes.

